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Outstanding People: Photo Description & Discussion

Objetivo: responder de forma natural, desarrollar ideas y usar lenguaje de especulación, descripción y opinión propio de un nivel B2.

A. Look at the picture and answer the questions

1. Who do you think the people taking a selfie are? Where are they?

I think one of them is a professional football player and the other one is a young fan. They are probably at a football stadium, near the pitch, just after or before a match.

Useful language: I think... , probably... , near the pitch...

2. What are the people around them doing?

The people around them are watching, taking photos and trying to get closer to the player. Some of them seem excited because they may also want a selfie or an autograph.

Useful language: seem excited , may also want...

3. What do you think they have just said to each other? What's going to happen next?

The fan has probably just asked, "Can I take a selfie with you?" and the player has agreed.

Next, they're going to take the photo, and the fan will probably thank him before leaving.

Grammar focus: Present Perfect + just , going to and will probably .

B. Discuss the questions

1. On what occasions do you normally take photos?

I normally take photos when I'm travelling, when I spend time with friends or family, and on special occasions such as birthdays or celebrations. I also take pictures when I see something unusual or beautiful that I want to remember.

2. If you could take a selfie with a famous person, who would you choose and why?

If I could take a selfie with a famous person, I would probably choose a successful athlete. I admire people who are disciplined and work hard to achieve their goals. I think it would be interesting to meet someone who performs at such a high level.

B2 structure: second conditional + reason + personal opinion.

3. What role do you think famous people play in society? Should they be good role models? Should they inspire other people?

I think famous people can have a strong influence on society, especially on young people. In my opinion, they should try to be good role models because many people follow what they do and say. However, I don't think they have to be perfect. They are still human beings and can make mistakes. The most important thing is that they use their influence in a responsible way and, if possible, inspire people to do something positive.

Useful connector: However... para introducir contraste y desarrollar una respuesta más equilibrada.

Useful B2 expressions for this type of task

? I think / I'd say... - para dar una opinión.

? They seem to be... - para describir sin afirmar demasiado.

? They might / may be... - para especular.

? It looks as if... - para interpretar una escena.

? In my opinion... - para desarrollar una idea.

? However... - para contrastar.

? If I could..., I would... - para respuestas hipotéticas.

Sigue practicando

Intenta responder primero sin leer el modelo y después compara tu respuesta con esta versión B2.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Countable & Uncountable Nouns

Countable nouns

Se pueden contar: one car, two cars . Tienen singular y plural.

Uncountable nouns

No suelen contarse individualmente: water, information, traffic, pollution .

Tipo Determinantes frecuentes Ejemplo Countable many, a few, several many cars Uncountable much, a little much traffic Ambos some, any, a lot of some cars / some water
Ojo: information no lleva plural. Di some information , no "informations".
Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.
Volver a todos los artículos ?

Currently: Meaning, Use, and a Spanish False Friend

In this article ? Meaning and use

? Bilingual examples

? Rules and common mistakes

? Practice

1. Meaning and use

Currently means "at the present time" or "now". It is useful in neutral and formal English when describing a situation in progress.

It is a false friend when Spanish corrientemente means normally, commonly, or ordinarily.

Choose the English word that matches the intended idea.

2. Bilingual examples

She is currently preparing for her Cambridge examination.

Actualmente se está preparando para su examen de Cambridge.

I normally work from home.

Normalmente trabajo desde casa.

This expression is commonly used.

Esta expresión se usa comúnmente.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Currently often appears before a main verb but after be: I currently work - Actualmente trabajo; I am currently working - Actualmente estoy trabajando. It can also begin a sentence.

Do not choose currently just because a Spanish sentence contains actualmente or corrientemente; first decide whether the meaning is now, normally, or commonly.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first, then check the Spanish meaning.

4. Practice

? Choose: I ____ take the train to work if you mean every day. (currently / normally)

? Translate: Actualmente estoy buscando trabajo.

Answers: normally · I am currently looking for work. - Actualmente estoy buscando trabajo. - Actualmente estoy buscando trabajo.

Mini challenge Write three original sentences using today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.

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How to Use a Dictionary & WordReference

No busques solo la traducción

Cuando consultes una palabra, comprueba también la categoría gramatical, pronunciación, ejemplos y colocaciones.

Checklist

? ¿Es noun, verb, adjective o adverb?

- ? ¿Es countable o uncountable?
- ? ¿Qué preposición usa?
- ? ¿Qué palabras suelen acompañarla?
- ? ¿Hay diferencias UK/US?

pollution (uncountable noun) ? air pollution, water pollution, reduce pollution.

Después, crea una frase propia. Esa frase te ayudará más que memorizar una traducción aislada.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Direct Speech and Reported Speech

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1. Meaning and use

Direct speech repeats exact words in quotation marks. Reported speech communicates the message without quoting every word.

With a past reporting verb, English often backshifts: present simple ? past simple; present continuous ? past continuous; present perfect ? past perfect; past simple ? past perfect.

2. Bilingual examples

"I am tired," she said. ? She said that she was tired.

«Estoy cansada», dijo. ? Dijo que estaba cansada.

"I have finished." ? He said he had finished.

«He terminado». ? Dijo que había terminado.

"I haven't submitted the report yet," he explained. ? He explained that he hadn't submitted the report yet.

«Todavía no he entregado el informe», explicó. ? Explicó que todavía no lo había entregado.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Pronouns and time/place expressions may change with the new viewpoint: tomorrow can become the next day, here can become there, and now can become then.

Backshift is not always compulsory when the information remains true. Meaning and context matter more than mechanical transformation.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first. Try to explain it before checking the Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Report: "I am leaving now," Ana said.

? Report: "I saw him yesterday," Luis said.

Answers: Ana said that she was leaving then. - Ana dijo que se iba entonces. · Luis said that he had seen him the day before. - Luis dijo que lo había visto el día anterior.

Mini challenge Write three original sentences with today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Return to the complete Easy English index for more grammar, vocabulary, and speaking practice.

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English Tenses: Quick Overview

Los seis tiempos clave

Tiempo Uso Ejemplo

Present Simple rutinas / hechos I work every day.

Present Continuous ahora / temporal I'm working now.

Present Perfect pasado conectado al presente I've finished.

Past Simple pasado terminado I worked yesterday.

Past Continuous acción en progreso en el pasado I was working at 8.

Past Perfect pasado anterior a otro pasado I had left before he arrived.

When y while

While suele acompañar una acción larga; when , una acción puntual.

While I was driving, my phone rang.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Learn English with TV Shows and Movies

1. A simple four-step method

? Watch for context. Notice who is speaking, where they are, and what is happening.

? Replay with English subtitles. Write down 3-5 useful expressions.

? Listen without reading. Try to recognize the expressions you studied.

? Imitate one sentence. Copy the rhythm and intonation.

Realistic goal: learning one reusable phrase is more valuable than translating every word in a long scene.

2. What works well for beginners?

Choose shows with everyday conversations, short episodes, and clear visual situations such as family life, friendships, school, work, restaurants, or travel.

3. How to choose movies

Stories you already know, animation, and family movies can be easier because the context lets you focus on the language. Avoid highly technical dialogue at first.

4. How to use subtitles

Stage Subtitles Goal 1 Your strongest language Understand context 2 English Connect sound and spelling 3 None Train listening

5. Phrases to listen for

? What's going on? - ¿Qué está pasando?

? Are you okay? - ¿Estás bien?

? I don't know. - No lo sé.

? Come on! - ¡Vamos!

? Wait a minute. - Espera un momento.

? What do you mean? - ¿Qué quieres decir?

? That's great! - ¡Eso es genial!

? See you later. - Hasta luego.

6. Weekly routine

Day Activity Monday Short scene + 5 expressions Tuesday Replay without subtitles Wednesday

Imitate 5 sentences aloud Thursday New scene + vocabulary Friday Review 10 expressions

Weekend Watch for enjoyment and notice what you recognize Keep learning Continue with another lesson and keep practicing.

View all lessons ?

Future: Going to & Present Continuous

Going to

Usa be going to + verbo para intenciones o planes que ya tienes.

I'm going to study tomorrow. - Voy a estudiar mañana.

Present Continuous para futuro

Usa am/is/are + -ing para planes más organizados, normalmente con tiempo o lugar acordados.

I'm leaving at eight tomorrow. - Me voy mañana a las ocho.

Forma Idea principal Ejemplo going to intención I'm going to call him. present continuous plan organizado I'm meeting him at 5.

Práctica

Elige la forma más natural: "I ____ my dentist at 10:00 tomorrow." ? I'm seeing my dentist.

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Volver a todos los artículos ?

Gerund & Infinitive

Gerund: verb + -ing

Algunos verbos suelen ir seguidos de gerundio: enjoy, avoid, finish, keep, suggest .

I enjoy learning English.

Infinitive: to + verb

Otros suelen ir seguidos de infinitivo: want, need, decide, hope, plan .

I want to improve my English.

Verbos que cambian de significado

Remember doing = recordar una experiencia; remember to do = acordarse de hacer algo.

I remember meeting her. / Remember to call her.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Phrasal Verbs with Get

Get: un verbo pequeño con muchos significados

Cuando get se combina con una partícula, el significado puede cambiar por completo. Aprende la expresión completa, no palabra por palabra.

Phrasal verb Significado Ejemplo

get up levantarse I get up at seven. - Me levanto a las siete.

get in entrar / llegar What time did you get in? - ¿A qué hora llegaste?

get out salir Get out of the car. - Sal del coche.

get off bajarse We get off at the next stop. - Nos bajamos en la próxima parada.

Truco: usamos get in/out of con coche o taxi y get on/off con bus, tren o avión.

Práctica

Completa: 1) I ____ up at 6:30. 2) We ____ off the bus downtown. 3) She ____ in late last night.

Respuestas: get · got · got.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Inspire People: A Natural English Collocation

In this article ? Meaning and use

? Bilingual examples

? Rules and common mistakes

? Practice

1. Meaning and use

To inspire someone is to give them enthusiasm, confidence, ideas, or motivation. Inspire people is a natural collocation in leadership, education, creativity, and everyday English.

A very useful pattern is inspire + person + to + base verb: The teacher inspired me to study languages.

2. Bilingual examples

Her story inspired many people.

Su historia inspiró a muchas personas.

The teacher inspired me to study languages.

El profesor me inspiró a estudiar idiomas.

Great leaders inspire people to exceed their own expectations.

Los grandes líderes inspiran a las personas a superar sus propias expectativas.

3. Rules and common mistakes

In more formal English, inspire can combine with nouns such as confidence, hope, and loyalty. Adverbs such as deeply or truly can add emphasis when needed.

Do not confuse inspire with motivate in every context. They overlap, but inspire often suggests creating enthusiasm, ideas, or a sense of possibility.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first, then check the Spanish meaning.

4. Practice

? Complete: His example inspired us ____ keep going.

? Translate: Su creatividad inspira a la gente.

Answers: to · Her creativity inspires people. - Su creatividad inspira a la gente. - Su creatividad inspira a la gente.

Mini challenge Write three original sentences using today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.

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Greetings and Introductions

1. Basic greetings

Hello! - ¡Hola! A neutral greeting for most situations.

Hi! - ¡Hola! A friendly, informal greeting.

Good morning. - Buenos días. Use it in the morning.

Good afternoon. - Buenas tardes. Use it after midday.

Good evening. - Buenas tardes/noches. Use it when greeting someone in the evening.

2. Introduce yourself

The simplest patterns are I'm + name and My name is + name .

Hi, I'm Alex. - Hola, soy Alex.

Hello, my name is Sara. - Hola, me llamo Sara.

3. Ask someone's name

Use What's your name? - ¿Cómo te llamas? In a more formal situation, you can say May I ask your name? - ¿Puedo preguntarte tu nombre?

4. Ask how someone is

How are you? - I'm fine, thanks.

¿Cómo estás? - Estoy bien, gracias.

How's it going? - Pretty good!

¿Qué tal? - ¡Bastante bien!

Tip: "How's it going?" is more informal than "How are you?"

5. Say goodbye

? Goodbye. - Adiós. Neutral.

? Bye! - ¡Adiós! Common and informal.

? See you later. - Hasta luego. You expect to meet again.

? Have a nice day! - ¡Que tengas un buen día! A friendly closing.

6. Practice

Complete the mini-dialogue: A: Hello! My ____ is Emma.

B: Hi Emma. ____ are you?

A: I'm fine, thanks. See you ____!

Answers: name · How · later

Keep learning Continue with another lesson and keep practicing.

View all lessons ?

The Verb "To Be"

1. The three present forms

Subject Form Example I am I am ready.

Estoy listo/a. he / she / it is She is here.

Ella está aquí. you / we / they are They are busy.

Están ocupados/as.

2. Contractions

In everyday English, contractions are very common: I'm, you're, he's, she's, it's, we're, they're .

3. Negative sentences

Put not after the verb: I am not tired. - No estoy cansado/a. She isn't late. - Ella no

llega tarde. We aren't ready. - No estamos listos/as.

4. Questions

Move the verb before the subject: Are you ready? - ¿Estás listo/a? Is she at home? - ¿Está ella en casa? Am I late? - ¿Llego tarde?

5. Essential uses

? Identity: I'm Marta. - Soy Marta.

? Profession: I'm a designer. - Soy diseñador/a.

? Origin: He is from Rome. - Él es de Roma.

? Feelings: We are hungry. - Tenemos hambre.

? Location: The keys are on the table. - Las llaves están sobre la mesa.

? Age: I'm 25. - Tengo 25 años.

Common mistake: English uses be for age. Say "I am 25" - "Tengo 25 años", not "I have 25".

6. Practice

Choose am, is, or are: ? I ____ ready.

? She ____ from Canada.

? We ____ friends.

? They ____ not at home.

? ____ you tired?

Answers: am · is · are · are · Are

Keep learning Continue with another lesson and keep practicing.

View all lessons ?

Simple Questions in English

1. Question words

Word Use Example What things / information What is your name?

¿Cómo te llamas? Where place Where do you live?

¿Dónde vives? Who person Who is she?

¿Quién es ella? When time When do you work?

¿Cuándo trabajas? Why reason Why are you tired?

¿Por qué estás cansado/a? How manner / condition How are you?

¿Cómo estás?

2. Questions with "to be"

When the main verb is am/is/are , put it before the subject: Where are you? - ¿Dónde estás?

Who is he? - ¿Quién es él?

3. Questions with other verbs

Use do with I/you/we/they and does with he/she/it: Where do you live? - ¿Dónde vives? Where does she work? - ¿Dónde trabaja ella?

Remember: after does , use the base verb: "Where does he work?" - "¿Dónde trabaja él?", not "works".

4. Useful "how" questions

? How are you? - ¿Cómo estás?

? How old are you? - ¿Cuántos años tienes?

? How much is it? - ¿Cuánto cuesta?

? How many? - ¿Cuántos/as?

? How often? - ¿Con qué frecuencia?

? How do you say ... in English? - ¿Cómo se dice ... en inglés?

5. Practice

Put the words in order: ? you / where / live / do?

? she / who / is?

? does / work / where / he?

Answers: Where do you live? - ¿Dónde vives? · Who is she? - ¿Quién es ella? · Where does he work? - ¿Dónde trabaja él?

Keep learning Continue with another lesson and keep practicing.

View all lessons ?

How to Use Might for Possibility

In this article ? Meaning and use

? Bilingual examples

? Rules and common mistakes

? Practice

1. Meaning and use

Might is a modal verb for possibility and uncertainty. It does not encode a fixed

percentage; context tells us how likely the speaker considers the event.

The form is might + base verb. There is no third-person -s and no to: He might come - Puede que venga; she might need help - Puede que necesite ayuda.

2. Bilingual examples

Take an umbrella; it might rain later.

Lleva un paraguas; puede que llueva más tarde.

She might be at work.

Puede que ella esté en el trabajo.

The shop might not be open.

Puede que la tienda no esté abierta.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Use might not + base verb for a possible negative situation: I might not go out tonight -

Puede que no salga esta noche.

Avoid "might to go" and "might goes". Like other central modal verbs, might is followed directly by the base form.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first. Try to explain it before checking the Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Correct: She might to arrive late.

? Complete: We ____ not have enough time.

Answers: She might arrive late. - Puede que llegue tarde. · might

Mini challenge Write three original sentences with today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Return to the complete Easy English index for more grammar, vocabulary, and speaking practice.

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Negative Prefixes in English

In this article ? Meaning and use

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1. Meaning and use

A negative prefix changes a word toward an opposite, negative, or incorrect meaning. English uses several prefixes, so learning common patterns is more reliable than translating directly from Spanish.

Un- is very common: happy ? unhappy; employed ? unemployed. In- often appears with Latin roots: accurate ? inaccurate; dependent ? independent. Before m or p, in- commonly becomes im-: possible ? impossible; patient ? impatient.

2. Bilingual examples

After losing his contract, he found himself unemployed for several months.

Después de perder su contrato, estuvo desempleado durante varios meses.

The information was inaccurate.

La información era imprecisa.

I misunderstood the question.

Malinterpreté la pregunta.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Dis- often expresses an opposite or absence: honest ? dishonest; agree ? disagree. Mis- usually means wrongly or badly: understand ? misunderstand; spell ? misspell.

Do not invent a prefix by analogy. English says impossible, not "unpossible". Learn the whole word when possible.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first. Try to explain it before checking the

Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Make the opposite: possible, employed, accurate, honest.

? Choose the correct word: I ____ the instructions. (misunderstood / disunderstood)

Answers: impossible, unemployed, inaccurate, dishonest. · misunderstood

Mini challenge Write three original sentences with today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Return to the complete Easy English index for more grammar, vocabulary, and speaking practice.

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Nonetheless: Formal Contrast in English

In this article ? Meaning and use

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1. Meaning and use

Nonetheless means nevertheless or even so. It introduces a statement that remains true despite the information just mentioned.

At the beginning of a sentence it is normally followed by a comma. It can also follow a semicolon when connecting two closely related independent clauses.

2. Bilingual examples

The task was difficult. Nonetheless, we completed it on time.

La tarea era difícil. No obstante, la terminamos a tiempo.

The schedule was demanding; nonetheless, everyone completed the course.

El horario era exigente; no obstante, todos completaron el curso.

The evidence was limited. Nonetheless, the team continued the study.

Las pruebas eran limitadas. No obstante, el equipo continuó el estudio.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Nonetheless is relatively formal. In everyday conversation, but, still, or even so may sound more natural.

Do not add formal connectors merely to sound advanced. Use nonetheless when the contrast between the two ideas is genuinely clear.

Study tip: Say the English example aloud before checking the Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Join with nonetheless: The weather was bad. We continued the trip.

? Is nonetheless generally more formal or less formal than but?

Answers: The weather was bad. Nonetheless, we continued the trip. - Hacía mal tiempo. No obstante, continuamos el viaje. · More formal.

Mini challenge Create a short two-person dialogue using at least two expressions from this article, then translate it into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.

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I Reckon, I Guess, I Believe, and It Seems Like

In this article ? Meaning and use

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1. Meaning and use

Hedging makes an opinion less absolute. It helps you show whether you are giving a personal view, a tentative deduction, or an impression based on evidence.

I reckon is informal and especially associated with British and Australian English. I guess is widespread and often tentative. I believe is neutral to slightly formal. It seems like focuses on an impression.

2. Bilingual examples

I reckon we should finish this task first.

Creo que deberíamos terminar esta tarea primero.

I guess they changed the date because of the weather.

Supongo que cambiaron la fecha por el tiempo.

I believe continuous learning is important.

Creo que el aprendizaje continuo es importante.

It seems like the update fixed the problem.

Parece que la actualización solucionó el problema.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Choose the expression according to register and meaning, not simply as four interchangeable versions of I think.

For formal writing, I believe or it seems that may fit better than I reckon. In natural conversation, I guess and it seems like are extremely useful.

Study tip: Say the English example aloud before checking the Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Which expression is especially informal British/Australian?

? Translate: Parece que están ocupados.

Answers: I reckon. - Yo diría / creo. - It seems like they're busy. / It seems that they're busy. - Parece que están ocupados.

Mini challenge Create a short two-person dialogue using at least two expressions from this article, then translate it into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.

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Take Off: Four Essential Meanings

In this article ? Meaning and use

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1. Meaning and use

Take off is a multi-meaning phrasal verb. With aircraft it means leave the ground; with clothing it means remove an item.

For success, a business, product, career, or trend can take off when it suddenly becomes popular or successful.

2. Bilingual examples

The flight is scheduled to take off at 8:30 a.m.

El vuelo está programado para despegar a las 8:30.

Please take off your coat.

Por favor, quítate el abrigo.

Her consultancy really took off last year.

Su consultoría despegó de verdad el año pasado.

He took two days off to recover.

Se tomó dos días libres para recuperarse.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Take time off means spend a period away from work or study. Notice the time expression between take and off: take two days off.

Context normally makes the meaning clear. With clothing, take off is separable: take off your coat / take your coat off.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first, then check the Spanish meaning.

4. Practice

? Translate: Me voy a tomar el viernes libre.

? What does take off mean in: The new app took off in June?

Answers: I'm going to take Friday off. - Voy a tomarme el viernes libre. · It became successful/popular quickly. - Se hizo popular / tuvo éxito rápidamente.

Mini challenge Write three original sentences using today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.

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Polite Disagreement: I Beg to Differ and Other Useful Phrases

In this article ? Meaning and use

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1. Meaning and use

Polite disagreement lets you challenge an idea while keeping the discussion collaborative. A useful pattern is acknowledgement + disagreement + reason.

I beg to differ is formal and somewhat traditional. Sorry to differ is polite and concise.

Sorry, but I disagree is direct, clear, and natural.

2. Bilingual examples

I beg to differ; face-to-face interaction still has important advantages.

Permíteme discrepar; la interacción cara a cara sigue teniendo ventajas importantes.

Sorry, but I disagree with that point.

Lo siento, pero no estoy de acuerdo con ese punto.

I see your point, but I think there is another factor to consider.

Entiendo tu punto, pero creo que hay otro factor que considerar.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Useful softeners include I see your point, but... - Entiendo tu punto, pero...; That's true to some extent, but... - Eso es cierto hasta cierto punto, pero...; and I'm not sure I agree because... - No estoy seguro/a de estar de acuerdo porque....

Politeness does not mean hiding your position. State the disagreement clearly, then support it with a reason, example, or alternative.

Study tip: Say the English example aloud before checking the Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Make this more polite: You're wrong. Online classes are better.

? Complete: I see your ____, but I'm not sure I agree.

Answers: Example: I see your point, but I think online classes have some important advantages. - Entiendo tu punto, pero creo que las clases en línea tienen algunas ventajas importantes. · point

Mini challenge Create a short two-person dialogue using at least two expressions from this article, then translate it into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.

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----- Political English: Vocabulary and Debate Phrases

In this article

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- ? Elections and campaigns
- ? Policies, law and public debate
- ? Giving your opinion
- ? Agreeing and building on an idea
- ? Disagreeing respectfully
- ? Asking for evidence and clarification
- ? Interrupting and managing a discussion
- ? Building a strong argument
- ? Common mistakes for Spanish speakers
- ? Exercises, answers and mini challenge

Learning focus: this article teaches language for understanding and discussing politics. The examples are intentionally neutral and do not support or oppose any party, candidate or political position.

1. Core political vocabulary

Start with the words that appear most often in news reports, elections, parliamentary debates and everyday conversations. Notice that some English words have several possible Spanish translations depending on context.

English Español Useful note

politics política The activity or study of government and public affairs.
political político/a Adjective: a political debate.
politician político/a A person professionally involved in politics.
government gobierno The group or system governing a country or region.
citizen ciudadano/a A legally recognized member of a state.
democracy democracia A system in which citizens participate in choosing government.
constitution constitución The fundamental legal framework of a state.
rights derechos Legal, civil or human entitlements.
freedom libertad The ability or right to act, speak or think without undue restriction.
public opinion opinión pública Views held by members of the public.
majority mayoría The larger number or part.
minority minoría The smaller number or part; it can also refer to a social group.

Public opinion can change over time. La opinión pública puede cambiar con el tiempo.

Citizens have both rights and responsibilities. Los ciudadanos tienen tanto derechos como responsabilidades.

The proposal received support from a majority of the committee. La propuesta recibió el apoyo de la mayoría del comité.

2. Government and institutions

English Español Example

parliament parlamento Parliament will debate the proposal. - El Parlamento debatirá la propuesta.

congress congreso Congress approved the measure. - El Congreso aprobó la medida.

legislature poder legislativo / legislatura The legislature is considering a new bill. - El poder legislativo está estudiando un nuevo proyecto de ley.

executive branch poder ejecutivo The executive branch implements laws. - El poder ejecutivo aplica las leyes.

judiciary poder judicial The judiciary interprets the law. - El poder judicial interpreta la ley.

head of state jefe/a de Estado The role of the head of state varies by country. - El papel del jefe de Estado varía según el país.

prime minister primer ministro / primera ministra The prime minister addressed parliament. - El primer ministro se dirigió al Parlamento.

minister ministro/a The minister answered questions. - El ministro respondió a preguntas.

mayor alcalde / alcaldesa The mayor announced a local plan. - La alcaldesa anunció un plan local.

opposition oposición The opposition requested more information. - La oposición pidió más información.

coalition coalición The parties formed a coalition. - Los partidos formaron una coalición.

cabinet gabinete / consejo de ministros The cabinet discussed the budget. - El consejo de ministros debatió el presupuesto.

Language note: institutional vocabulary changes across political systems. For example, Congress, Parliament and legislature are related ideas, but they are not always interchangeable.

3. Elections and campaigns

English Español Meaning

election elección / elecciones A formal process for choosing representatives or officeholders.

vote voto / votar A choice expressed in an election or decision.

voter votante / elector A person entitled to vote.

candidate candidato/a A person seeking elected office.

political party partido político An organized political group.

campaign campaña Organized activity to win support.

manifesto / platform programa electoral A set of policies or promises presented by a party or candidate.

poll encuesta A survey of opinion; not the same as the final election result.

polling station colegio electoral / centro de votación The place where people vote.

ballot papeleta / votación The paper or process used to cast a vote.

turnout participación electoral The proportion or number of eligible voters who vote.

referendum referéndum A direct public vote on a specific question.

term of office mandato The period someone holds an elected office.

incumbent titular del cargo / candidato en ejercicio The person who currently holds an office.

Voter turnout was higher than in the previous election. La participación electoral fue mayor que en las elecciones anteriores.

The candidates discussed their economic policies during the debate. Los candidatos hablaron de sus políticas económicas durante el debate.

An opinion poll is not the same as an election result. Una encuesta de opinión no es lo mismo que un resultado electoral.

4. Policies, law and public debate

English Español

policy política / medida / línea de actuación
public policy política pública
foreign policy política exterior
domestic policy política interior / interna
bill proyecto de ley
law ley
legislation legislación
amendment enmienda
regulation regulación / reglamento
budget presupuesto
public spending gasto público
tax / taxation impuesto / fiscalidad
public services servicios públicos
welfare bienestar / prestaciones sociales
reform reforma
proposal propuesta
measure medida
debate debate / debatir
issue tema / asunto / problema
stakeholder parte interesada / actor implicado

False friend: English policy normally means a plan, principle or course of action. It does not usually mean policía ; the English word for policía is police .

The government introduced a new housing policy. El gobierno presentó una nueva política de vivienda.

The committee proposed an amendment to the bill. El comité propuso una enmienda al proyecto de ley.

Public spending is one of the main issues in the debate. El gasto público es uno de los principales temas del debate.

5. Giving your opinion without sounding absolute

In a debate, good English is not only about vocabulary. You also need language that shows how certain you are and separates a fact from your personal interpretation.

In my view, ... Desde mi punto de vista, ...

In my opinion, ... En mi opinión, ...

From my perspective, ... Desde mi perspectiva, ...

As I see it, ... Tal como yo lo veo, ...

I would argue that ... Yo sostendría que ...

It seems to me that ... Me parece que ...

I tend to think that ... Suelo pensar que ...

My understanding is that ... Lo que yo entiendo es que ...

In my view, the proposal needs a clearer explanation of its costs. Desde mi punto de vista, la propuesta necesita una explicación más clara de sus costes.

I would argue that we should compare several sources before reaching a conclusion. Yo sostendría que deberíamos comparar varias fuentes antes de llegar a una conclusión.

6. Agreeing and building on an idea

Agreement can be complete or partial. In natural discussion, speakers often agree with one part of an argument and then add a qualification.

I agree with that. Estoy de acuerdo con eso.

I completely agree. Estoy completamente de acuerdo.

That's a fair point. Es un punto razonable.

I think you're right about that. Creo que tienes razón en eso.

I agree up to a point. Estoy de acuerdo hasta cierto punto.

I'd add that ... Añadiría que ...

Building on that point, ... Partiendo de ese punto, ...

That's true, and another factor is ... Eso es cierto, y otro factor es ...

That's a fair point. I'd add that local circumstances may also matter. Es un punto razonable. Añadiría que las circunstancias locales también pueden importar.

7. Disagreeing respectfully

Strong debates do not require aggressive language. A useful structure is acknowledge + disagree + reason . This makes your position clear without attacking the other person.

I see your point, but ... Entiendo tu punto, pero ...

I understand the argument, but I see it differently. Entiendo el argumento, pero yo lo veo de otra manera.

I'm not sure I agree with that. No estoy seguro/a de estar de acuerdo con eso.

I would challenge that assumption. Cuestionaría esa suposición.

That's one interpretation, but another is ... Esa es una interpretación, pero otra es ...

I agree with the goal, but not necessarily with the method. Estoy de acuerdo con el objetivo, pero no necesariamente con el método.

There may be another way to look at it. Puede haber otra manera de verlo.

I beg to differ. Permíteme discrepar.

I see your point, but I think the evidence allows more than one interpretation. Entiendo tu punto, pero creo que las pruebas permiten más de una interpretación.

I agree with the goal, but not necessarily with the method proposed. Estoy de acuerdo con el objetivo, pero no necesariamente con el método propuesto.

8. Asking for evidence, sources and clarification

These phrases are especially useful when a discussion includes statistics, historical claims or predictions. They help you examine an argument without immediately accepting or rejecting it.

What evidence supports that claim? ¿Qué pruebas respaldan esa afirmación?

Do you have a source for that figure? ¿Tienes una fuente para esa cifra?

How recent is that data? ¿Qué tan recientes son esos datos?

What period does that statistic cover? ¿Qué periodo abarca esa estadística?

Could you clarify what you mean by ...? ¿Podrías aclarar qué quieres decir con ...?

Are we talking about the same definition? ¿Estamos hablando de la misma definición?

Is that a fact or an interpretation? ¿Eso es un hecho o una interpretación?

How does that compare with other sources? ¿Cómo se compara eso con otras fuentes?

Do you have a source for that figure, and what period does it cover? ¿Tienes una fuente para esa cifra y qué periodo abarca?

9. Interrupting and managing a discussion politely

In real discussions, you may need to enter the conversation, stop a misunderstanding or return to the main question. These expressions help you do it politely.

May I come in here? ¿Puedo intervenir aquí?

Can I add something? ¿Puedo añadir algo?

Sorry to interrupt, but ... Perdona que interrumpa, pero ...

If I may, I'd like to respond to that point. Si me permites, me gustaría responder a ese punto.

Could we go back to the original question? ¿Podríamos volver a la pregunta original?

Let's separate those two issues. Separemos esos dos temas.

Before we move on, can I clarify one thing? Antes de seguir, ¿puedo aclarar una cosa?

Let me make sure I understood you correctly. Déjame asegurarme de que te he entendido correctamente.

10. Building a strong argument in English

A clear argument is easier to follow when you signal its structure. You can use this simple pattern:

? State your position. - Expón tu postura.

? Give a reason. - Da una razón.

? Add evidence or an example. - Añade pruebas o un ejemplo.

? Recognize a counterargument. - Reconoce un contraargumento.

? Explain your conclusion. - Explica tu conclusión.

Useful connectors

Function English Español

Adding Furthermore / In addition / Moreover Además / Asimismo

Contrasting However / Nevertheless / On the other hand Sin embargo / No obstante / Por otro lado

Giving a reason Because / Since / Given that Porque / Dado que

Giving an example For example / For instance Por ejemplo

Consequence Therefore / As a result / Consequently Por lo tanto / Como resultado / En consecuencia

Conceding Although / Even though / Admittedly Aunque / Si bien / Hay que reconocer que

Summarizing Overall / In short / To sum up En general / En resumen / Para resumir

In my view, the proposal deserves further discussion because its long-term costs are still unclear. For example, the current estimate covers only the first two years. Admittedly, the plan could bring benefits in the short term; however, I think the longer-term impact should also be considered. Desde mi punto de vista, la propuesta merece un debate más profundo porque sus costes a largo plazo todavía no están claros. Por ejemplo, la estimación actual solo cubre los dos primeros años. Hay que reconocer que el plan podría aportar beneficios a corto plazo; sin embargo, creo que también debería considerarse el impacto a más largo plazo.

How to summarize the other person's argument

If I understand you correctly, you're saying that ... Si te entiendo correctamente, estás diciendo que ...

So your main point is that ... Entonces, tu argumento principal es que ...

Would it be fair to say that ...? ¿Sería correcto decir que ...?

We seem to agree on ..., but disagree on ... Parece que estamos de acuerdo en ..., pero discrepamos en ...

11. Common mistakes for Spanish speakers

1. Politics, policy and police are different words

Politics can be controversial. La política puede ser controvertida.

The city changed its transport policy. La ciudad cambió su política de transporte.

The police closed the road. La policía cerró la carretera.

2. Discuss does not normally take "about"

Incorrect: We discussed about the proposal.

We discussed the proposal. Debátimos / hablamos sobre la propuesta.

We talked about the proposal. Hablamos sobre la propuesta.

3. Agree with a person, agree on a topic or decision

I agree with you. Estoy de acuerdo contigo.

We agree on the main objective. Estamos de acuerdo en el objetivo principal.

4. Evidence is usually uncountable

Usually avoid: an evidence / evidences.

There is not enough evidence to support that conclusion. No hay pruebas suficientes para respaldar esa conclusión.

They presented two pieces of evidence. Presentaron dos pruebas / dos elementos probatorios.

5. Data and statistics need context

When you cite a number, try to include the source, date, population and time period. This is useful English and also makes a debate more precise.

According to the report, the figure increased between 2024 and 2025. Según el informe, la cifra aumentó entre 2024 y 2025.

6. Avoid attacking the person instead of the argument

In academic, professional and civic discussion, focus on the claim, evidence or assumption.

I disagree with that argument because the evidence is incomplete. No estoy de acuerdo con ese argumento porque las pruebas están incompletas.

Could we focus on the proposal rather than the person presenting it? ¿Podríamos centrarnos en la propuesta en lugar de en la persona que la presenta?

Study tip: choose five phrases from this article and practise them as complete sentence starters. In a real debate, retrieving a whole phrase such as I see your point, but... is much easier than building it word by word.

12. Practice

Exercise 1 - Vocabulary

Choose the best English word.

? Un proyecto de ley: law / bill / ballot

? Participación electoral: turnout / term / cabinet

? Una encuesta de opinión: poll / policy / parliament

? Una enmienda: amendment / government / candidate

? Gasto público: public spending / public opinion / public office

Answers: 1. bill · 2. turnout · 3. poll · 4. amendment · 5. public spending.

Exercise 2 - Make the disagreement more respectful

Rewrite each sentence with a polite debate phrase.

? You're wrong. The data is bad.

? That idea makes no sense.

? No. There is only one explanation.

Possible answers:

I'm not sure I agree. I think we should look more closely at how the data was collected. No estoy seguro/a de estar de acuerdo. Creo que deberíamos analizar más detenidamente cómo se recopilaron los datos.

I understand the argument, but I see it differently because there may be practical difficulties. Entiendo el argumento, pero yo lo veo de otra manera porque puede haber dificultades prácticas.

That's one interpretation, but another explanation may also fit the evidence. Esa es una interpretación, pero otra explicación también podría encajar con las pruebas.

Exercise 3 - Ask for better evidence

Complete the questions.

? What _____ supports that claim?

? Do you have a _____ for that figure?

? How _____ is that data?

? What period does that statistic _____?

Answers: 1. evidence · 2. source · 3. recent · 4. cover.

Exercise 4 - Translate into English

? Desde mi punto de vista, necesitamos más información antes de decidir.

? Entiendo tu punto, pero creo que hay otro factor que considerar.

? ¿Qué pruebas respaldan esa afirmación?

? Parece que estamos de acuerdo en el objetivo, pero discrepamos en el método.

? ¿Podríamos volver a la pregunta original?

Possible answers:

? In my view, we need more information before deciding. - Desde mi punto de vista, necesitamos más información antes de decidir.

? I see your point, but I think there is another factor to consider. - Entiendo tu punto, pero creo que hay otro factor que considerar.

? What evidence supports that claim? - ¿Qué pruebas respaldan esa afirmación?

? We seem to agree on the goal, but disagree on the method. - Parece que estamos de acuerdo en el objetivo, pero discrepamos en el método.

? Could we go back to the original question? - ¿Podríamos volver a la pregunta original?

Mini challenge - A 60-second debate

Choose a neutral public-policy topic such as public transport, school timetables, recycling or the use of public space. Speak for 60 seconds and include:

? one phrase for giving your opinion;

? one reason and one example;

? one phrase that recognizes a counterargument;

? one phrase asking for evidence;

? one conclusion.

Model opening:

In my view, the proposal is worth considering because it could improve access to public transport. For example, longer service hours may help people who work late. Admittedly, it could increase costs. However, before reaching a conclusion, I would like to know what evidence supports the cost estimate. Desde mi punto de vista, vale la pena considerar la propuesta porque podría mejorar el acceso al transporte público. Por ejemplo, ampliar el horario del servicio puede ayudar a las personas que trabajan hasta tarde. Hay que reconocer que podría aumentar los costes. Sin embargo, antes de llegar a una conclusión, me gustaría saber qué pruebas respaldan la estimación de costes.

Keep learning

Continue with polite disagreement and opinion language to make your discussions clearer and more natural.

Next: Polite Disagreement ?

Back to the main index ?

Pollution & Environment Vocabulary

Tipos de contaminación

English Español

air pollution contaminación del aire water pollution contaminación del agua soil pollution

contaminación del suelo noise pollution contaminación acústica plastic pollution

contaminación por plástico

Palabras clave

English Español Ejemplo

emissions emisiones Vehicle emissions affect air quality.

waste residuos We should reduce waste.

litter basura tirada Don't leave litter on the beach.

sewage aguas residuales Sewage can contaminate rivers.

landfill vertedero Too much waste ends up in landfill.

recycling reciclaje Recycling saves resources.

renewable energy energía renovable Renewable energy can reduce emissions.

environment medio ambiente We must protect the environment.

Verbos útiles

reduce, reuse, recycle, protect, prevent, contaminate, pollute, emit, dump, clean up.

Pollution es incontable: di pollution is a problem , no "pollutions are".

Speaking

In my view, cities should improve public transport to reduce air pollution.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Present Perfect: Never vs. Haven't ... Yet

In this article ? Meaning and use

? Bilingual examples

? Rules and common mistakes

? Practice

1. Meaning and use

Both forms connect the past with the present, but they express different ideas. Never means "at no time up to now"; not ... yet means "not until now" and often suggests an expected action.

Use have/has + never + past participle. Never already has a negative meaning, so do not add not: I have never been to New York.

2. Bilingual examples

I have never been to New York.

Nunca he estado en Nueva York.

I haven't received the confirmation email yet.

Todavía no he recibido el correo de confirmación.

Have you spoken to Marta yet?

¿Ya has hablado con Marta?

3. Rules and common mistakes

In negative present-perfect sentences, yet normally goes at the end: I haven't received the email yet. It is also common in questions: Have you finished yet? - ¿Ya has terminado?

Compare: I've never written a novel - Nunca he escrito una novela - describes life experience; I haven't finished my novel yet - Todavía no he terminado mi novela - describes an unfinished expected action.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first. Try to explain it before checking the Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Correct: I haven't never visited London.

? Complete: She ____ finished the assignment ____.

Answers: I have never visited London. - Nunca he visitado Londres. - hasn't / yet

Mini challenge Write three original sentences with today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Return to the complete Easy English index for more grammar, vocabulary, and

speaking practice.

Back to the main index ?

Present Perfect vs. Past Simple

Past Simple

Se usa para acciones terminadas en un momento pasado terminado.

I visited London in 2024. - Visité Londres en 2024.

Present Perfect

Se usa cuando conectamos el pasado con el presente, hablamos de experiencia o de un periodo que continúa.

I've visited London three times. - He visitado Londres tres veces.

For, since y yet

Palabra Uso Ejemplo for duración I've lived here for two years. since inicio I've lived here since 2024. yet todavía / ya I haven't finished yet.

Irregulares: go-went-gone, see-saw-seen, do-did-done.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Revenue Office and Supporters

In this article ? Meaning and use

? Bilingual examples

? Rules and common mistakes

? Practice

1. Meaning and use

A revenue office is a government office or department connected with collecting taxes or public revenue. The official institutional name varies by country.

Supporters are people who actively support, encourage, follow, or advocate for a team, cause, organization, or public figure.

2. Bilingual examples

He went to the local revenue office to ask about his tax return.

Fue a la oficina de Hacienda local para preguntar por su declaración de impuestos.

Thousands of supporters gathered outside the stadium.

Miles de aficionados se reunieron fuera del estadio.

The charity has many supporters.

La organización benéfica tiene muchos colaboradores.

3. Rules and common mistakes

Useful tax vocabulary includes tax return, taxpayer, income tax, tax bill, and tax refund.

With supporters, context determines whether Spanish needs aficionados, seguidores, partidarios, or colaboradores.

Fan is especially common for sport and entertainment; supporter can imply active backing; follower is common for social media and can also describe someone who follows a person or movement.

Study tip: Read the English sentence aloud first, then check the Spanish meaning.

4. Practice

? Translate: Tengo una cita en la oficina de Hacienda.

? Which is usually more natural for an entertainer: fan or supporter?

Answers: I have an appointment at the revenue/tax office. - Tengo una cita en la oficina de Hacienda. · fan

Mini challenge Write three original sentences using today's target language and translate them into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.
Back to the main index ?

Reading: Skimming & Scanning

Skimming

Leer rápidamente para captar la idea general. Mira título, subtítulos, primeras frases y palabras repetidas.

Objetivo: ¿De qué trata el texto?

Scanning

Buscar un dato concreto sin leer todo: una fecha, nombre, cifra, lugar o palabra clave.

Objetivo: ¿Dónde aparece la información que necesito?

Método de 3 pasos

? Skim: entiende el tema general.

? Lee la pregunta.

? Scan: busca las palabras clave y comprueba el contexto.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

Stative Verbs

¿Qué son?

Los stative verbs describen estados, opiniones, emociones, posesión o percepción, no acciones dinámicas.

Grupo Ejemplos Opinión know, believe, understand Emoción love, like, hate, prefer Posesión have, own, belong Percepción seem, appear, need

Normalmente: I know the answer. No "I'm knowing the answer".

Algunos verbos pueden ser dinámicos con otro significado: I'm having lunch es correcto porque have significa "tomar/comer".

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?

The Rings of Power: learn English with Season 1 subtitles

Contents

? Where to find the English subtitles

? Season 1 episodes

? How to study each episode

? Useful vocabulary for fantasy stories

? Common mistakes

? Practice

1. Where to find the English subtitles

Season 1 of The Lord of the Rings: The Rings of Power is available on Prime Video with English [CC] . These are the official closed captions provided with the series.

Official subtitle source

Open Season 1 in Prime Video, start an episode, open the subtitles menu and choose English [CC] .

Open Season 1 on Prime Video ?

Copyright note: this study guide does not reproduce complete subtitle files or episode transcripts. It points you to the official English captions and gives you original exercises to use with them.

2. Season 1 episodes

S01E01 · A Shadow of the Past Focus: introductions, warnings and descriptions of danger.

S01E02 · Adrift Focus: requests for help, uncertainty and survival vocabulary.

S01E03 · Adar Focus: commands, questions and formal conversation.

S01E04 · The Great Wave Focus: predictions, decisions and consequences.

S01E05 · Partings Focus: plans, promises and saying goodbye.

S01E06 · Udûn Focus: urgent instructions and action vocabulary.

S01E07 · The Eye Focus: reactions, loss, recovery and finding safety.

S01E08 · Alloyed Focus: discoveries, persuasion and conclusions.

3. A subtitle method for every episode

Step What to do Goal

1 Watch 5-10 minutes with English [CC]. Connect pronunciation with written English.

2 Pause only for useful words or short expressions. Avoid translating everything.

3 Write down 5 new items and make your own sentences. Turn passive vocabulary into active English.

4 Replay the same section without subtitles. Check what you can now hear.

5 Repeat two short lines aloud in your own voice. Practice rhythm and pronunciation.

4. Useful vocabulary for fantasy stories

English Spanish Original example

realm reino / territorio The travellers entered a distant realm.

Los viajeros entraron en un reino lejano.

oath juramento He refused to break his oath.

Se negó a romper su juramento.

forge forjar They learned how to forge a stronger tool.

Aprendieron a forjar una herramienta más resistente.

threat amenaza The village prepared for a possible threat.

El pueblo se preparó para una posible amenaza.

ally aliado/a She needed an ally she could trust.

Necesitaba un aliado en quien pudiera confiar.

fate destino He wondered whether he could change his fate.

Se preguntó si podría cambiar su destino.
wander vagar / deambular They wandered through the hills for days.
Vagaron por las colinas durante días.
ruler gobernante The ruler listened before making a decision.
El gobernante escuchó antes de tomar una decisión.

5. Common mistakes for Spanish speakers

Do not try to understand every word
Fantasy stories contain names, invented terms and formal vocabulary. First identify the action, the speaker's intention and the key verbs.

Do not keep Spanish subtitles on during the listening stage
If your goal is listening practice, switch to English [CC]. Spanish subtitles are useful for checking meaning, but they can make you read Spanish instead of listening to English.

Closed captions include sound information
English [CC] can include descriptions such as music or sound effects. Treat those descriptions as extra vocabulary rather than dialogue you need to memorize.

6. Practice

A. Match the words with their meanings.

- ? oath
- ? ally
- ? threat
- ? realm

a) a person who supports you · b) a serious promise · c) a possible danger · d) a kingdom or territory

Answers: 1-b, 2-a, 3-c, 4-d.

B. Mini challenge. Watch five minutes of any Season 1 episode with English [CC]. Write down three verbs you hear, then create a new sentence with each verb. Replay the same five minutes without subtitles and see whether you can recognize them.

Keep learning Review the general TV & Movies method, then return to this guide for your next episode.

Open the TV & Movies study method ?

Think Before You Speak

In this article

? Why thinking first matters

? Useful phrases to give yourself time

? A simple three-question filter

? Common communication mistakes

? Practice

1. Why thinking first matters

Speaking quickly is not always the same as speaking well. In a conversation, a short pause can help you understand what you really want to say, choose a better tone, and avoid words you may regret later.

In English, you do not need to answer immediately. Native and fluent speakers often use short expressions to create thinking time. These phrases can make you sound calmer and more natural, not less confident.

Main idea: A pause is not an empty space. It can be a moment to choose a clearer, kinder and more useful response.

2. Useful phrases to give yourself time

These expressions are useful when you need a few seconds before answering.

Let me think for a moment.
Déjame pensar un momento.

That's a good question.
Es una buena pregunta.

I'm not sure how to put it.
No estoy seguro/a de cómo expresarlo.

What I mean is...
Lo que quiero decir es...

Let me rephrase that.
Déjame decirlo de otra manera.

I need a second to think about that.
Necesito un segundo para pensar en eso.

Notice that these phrases do two things: they give you time and they tell the other person what is happening. That makes the pause feel natural.

3. A simple three-question filter

Before saying something important, ask yourself three quick questions:

1. Is it true?
Do I know this, or am I assuming it?
2. Is it useful?
Will saying this help the conversation move forward?
3. Can I say it better?
Can I express the same idea more clearly or respectfully?

This does not mean avoiding disagreement. You can be direct without being careless.

Too immediate More thoughtful

You're wrong.
Estás equivocado/a. I see it differently.
Yo lo veo de otra manera.
That makes no sense.

Eso no tiene sentido. I'm not sure I understand the reasoning.
No estoy seguro/a de entender el razonamiento.
I don't care.
No me importa. It's not my main concern right now.
No es mi principal preocupación ahora mismo.

4. Common communication mistakes

Answering before you understand. If the question is unclear, ask for clarification first.

Could you clarify what you mean?
¿Podrías aclarar qué quieres decir?

Using absolute words too quickly. Words such as always and never can make a disagreement sound stronger than you intend.

You never listen.
Nunca escuchas.

I don't feel heard in this conversation.
No siento que se me esté escuchando en esta conversación.

Confusing honesty with harshness. Being honest does not require the strongest possible wording. Clear language is often more effective when it focuses on the idea or situation rather than attacking the person.

Study tip: When practising speaking, deliberately wait two seconds before answering. Use one thinking phrase, then give your response.

5. Practice

? Translate into English: "Déjame pensar un momento."

? Make this sentence more thoughtful: "You're wrong."

? Complete: "I'm not sure how to ____ it."

? Which question helps you check your tone: "Is it true?", "Is it useful?" or "Can I say it better?"

Answers: 1. Let me think for a moment. - Déjame pensar un momento. 2. Example: I see it differently. - Yo lo veo de otra manera. 3. put. 4. Can I say it better?

Mini challenge

Imagine a friend says something you strongly disagree with. Give yourself two seconds, use one thinking phrase, and then respond without using "You're wrong." Write your answer in English and translate it into Spanish.

Keep learning

Practise respectful disagreement with more useful expressions.

Read "Polite Disagreement" ?

To Be Honest: A Conversational Discourse Marker

In this article ? Meaning and use

- ? Bilingual examples
- ? Rules and common mistakes
- ? Practice

1. Meaning and use

To be honest introduces a frank or personal comment. It often signals that the speaker is about to say what they genuinely think or feel.

It commonly appears at the beginning followed by a comma, but it can also appear later: I don't like it, to be honest.

2. Bilingual examples

To be honest, I found the first module difficult.

Sinceramente, el primer módulo me pareció difícil.

To be honest, I'd rather stay home.

La verdad, preferiría quedarme en casa.

I don't like it, to be honest.

No me gusta, la verdad.

3. Rules and common mistakes

It is natural in speech and informal or semi-formal writing. In a formal report or academic essay, more neutral phrasing is usually preferable.

Avoid using it at the start of every answer. Repetition can sound mechanical and may accidentally imply that other statements are less honest.

Study tip: Say the English example aloud before checking the Spanish translation.

4. Practice

? Add punctuation: To be honest I expected a different result.

? Translate: La verdad, todavía no lo sé.

Answers: To be honest, I expected a different result. - La verdad, esperaba un resultado diferente. · To be honest, I still don't know. - La verdad, todavía no lo sé.

Mini challenge Create a short two-person dialogue using at least two expressions from this article, then translate it into Spanish.

Keep learning Explore more Easy English lessons from the main page.

Back to the main index ?

El truco del bolígrafo para hablar inglés con más calma

En este artículo

? Por qué puede ayudar tener un boli en la mano

? El boli y la postura cuando estás sentado

? Cómo usarlo durante el thinking time

? Usarlo como recordatorio de conectores

? Cómo practicarlo antes del examen

1. ¿Por qué puede ayudar tener un boli en la mano al hablar?

Cuando estamos nerviosos, parte de esa tensión suele aparecer en el cuerpo: movemos las manos sin saber dónde ponerlas, tocamos la mesa, nos frotamos los dedos, balanceamos una pierna o cambiamos constantemente de postura. En una prueba oral, esos movimientos también pueden robarnos atención justo cuando necesitamos pensar en vocabulario, gramática y pronunciación.

Sostener un bolígrafo de forma relajada puede dar a las manos una tarea sencilla y estable . En vez de preguntarte inconscientemente qué hacer con ellas, ya tienen un lugar y un objeto concreto. Para algunas personas, esto hace que la energía nerviosa se exprese de una manera más discreta y controlada.

La idea clave: el bolígrafo funciona como un anclaje.

No "elimina" mágicamente los nervios. Su utilidad está en ofrecerte una referencia física constante: notas el boli, relajas la mano, respiras y vuelves a concentrarte en lo que quieres decir.

Esto es especialmente interesante cuando estás sentado . Al no poder desplazarte por el espacio como harías en una presentación de pie, toda la tensión puede concentrarse en manos, piernas y hombros. Un boli sostenido suavemente puede ayudarte a canalizar parte de esa inquietud y a recordar que no necesitas moverte continuamente.

Importante: no aprietes el bolígrafo con fuerza ni juegues con él de forma constante. Si lo giras, haces clic repetidamente o golpeas la mesa, puede convertirse en una distracción. La clave es sujetarlo con naturalidad.

2. El boli puede ayudarte a estabilizar la postura

En un examen oral es frecuente empezar a balancearse en la silla o mover las piernas cuando aumenta la tensión. Puedes utilizar el bolígrafo como una señal para volver a una posición estable.

1. Pies apoyados Mantén ambos pies en el suelo siempre que te resulte cómodo.

2. Hombros relajados No intentes parecer rígido. Una postura estable funciona mejor si sigue siendo natural.

3. Boli apoyado suavemente Puedes sostenerlo entre los dedos o dejar la mano con el boli sobre el papel o la mesa.

4. Mirada al examinador El bolígrafo es un apoyo, no el centro de tu atención. Después de la pausa, vuelve a mirar a la persona con la que estás hablando.

Con práctica puedes crear una asociación muy simple:

Boli ? relajar la mano ? respirar ? organizar la idea ? hablar.

3. Úsalo durante el thinking time

Uno de los errores más comunes en un speaking es intentar responder en el mismo instante en que termina la pregunta. Una pausa breve puede ser completamente natural y darte tiempo para preparar el comienzo de tu respuesta.

Cuando recibas una pregunta difícil, sujeta el boli con calma, toma aire y piensa en una sola idea inicial. Puedes acompañar esa pausa con una expresión natural:

Well, that's an interesting question.

Bueno, es una pregunta interesante.

Let me think for a moment.

Déjame pensar un momento.

I haven't really thought about that before, but...

La verdad es que no había pensado antes en eso, pero...

No necesitas construir toda la respuesta en tu cabeza. Decide únicamente qué opinas y cuál será tu primera razón . Después puedes desarrollar el resto mientras hablas.

4. Convierte el boli en un recordatorio de conectores

También puedes asociar una pequeña presión de los dedos sobre el bolígrafo con el momento de introducir una nueva idea. Así el gesto se convierte en una señal para estructurar el discurso.

Para añadir información

Furthermore, ... / In addition, ...
Además...

Para contrastar

However, ... / On the other hand, ...
Sin embargo... / Por otro lado...

Para expresar opinión

In my opinion, ... / Personally, I think...
En mi opinión... / Personalmente, creo que...

Para poner un ejemplo

For example, ... / For instance, ...
Por ejemplo...

El objetivo no es hacer un gesto visible cada vez que utilizas un conector. Lo importante es crear durante la práctica una asociación mental entre pausa, estructura y continuación .

5. Una estructura rápida para no quedarse en blanco

Cuando escuches una pregunta, puedes pensar en esta secuencia:

Pause ? Opinion ? Reason ? Example ? Conclusion Haz una pequeña pausa, da tu opinión, explica una razón, añade un ejemplo y cierra la idea.

Por ejemplo, ante la pregunta:

Do you think learning English through films is useful?

Una respuesta sencilla pero bien estructurada podría ser:

Well, I think it can be very useful because you hear English in real situations. For example, watching a series with English subtitles can help you learn common expressions. However, I think it should be combined with grammar and speaking practice. Creo que puede ser muy útil porque escuchas inglés en situaciones reales. Por ejemplo, ver una serie con subtítulos en inglés puede ayudarte a aprender expresiones habituales. Sin embargo, creo que debería combinarse con gramática y práctica oral.

6. Prácticalo antes del examen

El día del examen no debería ser la primera vez que intentas esta técnica. Practica en casa exactamente en una posición parecida a la del speaking: sentado frente a una mesa, con un bolígrafo en la mano y respondiendo preguntas durante uno o dos minutos.

Comprueba que el boli te ayuda a estar más estable. Si empieza a distraerte, a hacerte girarlo continuamente o a producir movimientos repetitivos, déjalo sobre la mesa. La estrategia solo es útil si hace que tu atención vuelva a la respuesta.

Mini practice

Responde durante aproximadamente un minuto:

Do you think people learn languages better by studying or by using them in real situations?

? Respira y haz una pausa breve.

? Piensa en tu opinión.

? Da una razón.

? Añade un ejemplo.

? Utiliza al menos un conector.

Puedes empezar con: "Well, in my opinion..."

Antes del examen: comprueba las normas concretas de tu prueba. Algunos formatos permiten tomar notas o usar papel y bolígrafo en determinadas partes y otros no.

Sigue practicando Speaking Combina esta técnica con expresiones de opinión, contraste y desacuerdo para que tus respuestas suenen más organizadas y naturales.
Ver todos los artículos de Speaking ?

Useful Vocabulary Review

Vocabulary

English Español Ejemplo

key clave / esencial Communication is key.

awareness concienciación / conocimiento We need greater awareness.

seabed fondo marino Plastic can reach the seabed.

lorry camión (UK) A lorry delivered the goods.

truck camión (US) The truck is fully loaded.

load carga / cargar They loaded the truck.

Consejo: aprende cada palabra con una frase corta y una colocación, no aislada.

Sigue estudiando Vuelve al índice para elegir otro tema del PDF de hoy.

Volver a todos los artículos ?